Having read the earlier chapters you must've reached a clear idea of what features and functionality you can expect from a Chrome OS experience. Connecting those aspects to an "outdated" machine - laptop or desktop - doesn't significantly change its operations in any way and is a great way to pass down technology to others like kids for educational purposes, where the need to be connected to the internet is high or to repurpose it as a home office set up which is connected to your office files via the cloud. The possibilities of how you can reorient your homelife to stay connected via WiFi across different rooms and even different cities (depending on your internet connectivity).

The only assumptions we make in this guide is that your older machines still have functional access to either Ethernet or WiFi connections, and have all the basic necessary components in working order. Apart from the minimum system requirements described next it is also worth having your old system serviced at least once to make sure that its Ethernet and WiFi connectivity is still compatible to the current standards. If your network adaptors are not capable of supporting current network speeds on cable, broadband and Wi-Fi, then the project as a whole would not be of much good. The only thing you would need to do next is wipe the settled dust off the machine and get it cleaned up for its marriage with Chrome OS.

Minimum system requirements

The Chrome OS architecture is very scalable and is already found on a variety of hardware configurations in the Chromebook, Chromestation and Chromedesk formats. So there are very limited considerations for its minimum requirements when considering it for an older system. Looking at the prepackaged systems from Google you can easily expect a smooth experience with just 2GB of RAM, a 1.4 GHz processor and 16GB of storage. However, in our tests we have seen Chromium OS work satisfactorily with 512MB of RAM, 1.4 GHz processor and 8GB of storage as well.

If you intend on using the Chrome OS enabled device for kids and basic office functionality the latter described configuration would be perfect. Otherwise 2GB of RAM would be recommended with 8GB or greater storage. It's important to remember that some key features of Chrome OS such as its famed super fast booting and standby features can't be replicated without the proprietary hardware used by Google in its Chromebooks. But as far as a cost effective cloud connected appliance computer is concerned you can't go wrong with Chrome OS on any outdated machine – laptop or desktop.